

Google Answers

At Google Answers, you pay for getting your questions answered. There are several aspects to <http://answers.google.com>—and we will talk about whatever is important and interesting.

First off, Answers don't come cheap—unless you earn in dollars. You'll understand why we say this as you go along. Besides, with this book to help you out, you might not need to ask questions at Google Answers at all, unless you're doing important business research and such.

5.1 How It Works

We'll leave out the details of what you go about clicking and so on, since you can figure that out for yourselves when you visit the site. What we'll do here is give you a clear picture of what Answers is intended to achieve.

It's a paid service, like we said, but with the important difference that even those who aren't paying or getting paid can contribute to the answering process!

Let's take a scenario. You've been Googling away for a couple of days, looking for an answer to a question—say, “What is the state of nanotechnology funding in the EU vis-à-vis that in the US, and where are the real advances expected?” Now such a question doesn't easily lend itself to Googling, because even if you use “EU nanotechnology funding,” you'll get a lot of results—and if you're doing serious research, it's difficult to compile all that information. That's where Google Answerers come in.

These folks are actually pretty ordinary. A few of them are experts in some fields, but most importantly, they're *good Googlers*. So what happens now is: